

Company Profile and Policy Guide

LVB-00 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Chief Executive Officer | Document page 1 of 2

1. Fictional organization and operating model

1.1 Purpose and boundaries

Lumen Vale Bank (LVB) is an entirely fictional community bank created for an academic retrieval-augmented generation project. Its locations, personnel roles, products, contacts, currency, limits, holidays, and rules are invented. No claim is made that the bank exists, holds a banking license, or complies with any jurisdiction's law. This corpus is educational test data, not a manual for operating a real bank.

LVB serves personal customers and small businesses in the fictional region of Alder County. It has 180 employees, one head office, four branches, and a customer-service team. Its fictional services are transaction accounts, savings accounts, domestic payments, and small-business lending. International transfers, investment advice, cryptocurrency custody, and insurance sales are outside this corpus. No product rates, loan approval criteria, or real customer records are supplied.

1.2 Organizational responsibilities

The Board approves policy and oversees risk. The Chief Executive Officer coordinates operations. The Head of Operations owns branch processes; each Branch Manager supervises local execution. People Operations owns employment records and leave. The Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) owns security standards, while the Service Desk administers access under approved requests.

The Data Protection Officer (DPO) handles privacy rights and disclosure assessments. The Compliance Officer owns customer due diligence and misconduct intake. The Finance Controller manages expenses and financial reconciliation. Internal Audit independently reviews controls and reports to the Board Audit Committee; it does not operate the controls it audits. An Independent Speak-Up Reviewer handles allegations against senior control staff.

1.3 Workplace and service hours

The standard full-time schedule is 40 hours per week, Monday to Friday, normally 09:00-17:00 Lumen time, with breaks scheduled by the manager. Branch customer hours are 09:00-16:00 on business days. A business day excludes weekends and the fictional holidays in LVB-05 section 2.3. Lumen time is a fictional local time convention; no real-world timezone conversion is intended. A business-day deadline ends at 17:00 unless a policy gives another time. Calendar days include weekends and holidays.

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2. How to use this policy corpus

2.1 Shared definitions and channels

CU means fictional currency units. Monetary thresholds are internal teaching examples, not legal reporting thresholds. Employees include permanent, part-time, and fixed-term staff; contractors follow applicable security, privacy, and conduct requirements but do not receive employee leave benefits under this corpus.

PolicyHub is the internal policy library. StaffHub is the leave, expense, and workplace-request portal. CaseTrack holds incident, privacy, misconduct, customer-review, and control cases in separate restricted queues. AccessDesk holds access requests. These systems and the addresses below are fictional labels, not working services. An emergency security report goes to the on-call Security queue in CaseTrack; a telephone fallback is described as the internal on-call directory, with no real phone number supplied.

2.2 Authority, versions, and conflicts

All documents are version 1.0, effective 1 October 2026, with a planned review on 1 October 2027. They are draft synthetic policies for academic review. The policy owner maintains content; the fictional Board is the designated approval authority. The effective date is a scenario assumption, not evidence of actual approval. No previous versions are part of the index.

Specific rules govern their stated topic: LVB-01 credentials; LVB-02 security incidents; LVB-03 protected reporting; LVB-04 branch operations; LVB-05 leave and separation; LVB-06 privacy and retention; LVB-07 conduct; LVB-08 internal controls; LVB-09 customer due diligence; LVB-10 communication; LVB-11 remote work and expenses. If two requirements apply, meet both. If they cannot both be met, pause the affected activity and ask both owners for a written resolution. Staff must not choose whichever rule is easier.

2.3 Records and interpretation

Use a case or request ID, role names, timestamps, decision, and supporting evidence in records; do not copy unnecessary personal data. Retention is defined by LVB-06 section 2.2. A legal or investigation hold suspends ordinary deletion until the hold owner releases it in writing. A missing policy is not permission: ask the responsible owner, and do not invent an entitlement or approval rule.

This corpus contains no real customer or employee personal data, credentials, emergency codes, vault combinations, or live banking endpoints. Any academic application must state that it answers only about these fictional policies. An unanswered question should be identified as unsupported rather than answered from assumed banking practice.

Password and Authentication Policy

LVB-01 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
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1. Credential standards and enrollment

1.1 Scope and ownership

This policy covers workforce authentication to LVB-managed applications, devices, privileged accounts, and remote access. Customer online-banking authentication is outside scope. Every workforce account must identify one person or an approved service. Shared human accounts are prohibited, including shared branch teller logins. Managers sponsor access; the Service Desk provisions it through AccessDesk after the required approval.

1.2 Password and multifactor requirements

Human-account passwords must contain at least 14 characters. Staff must use a unique password for each bank system where a separate password is needed and must not reuse a personal password. The system checks proposed passwords against a blocked list of common or compromised values. The bank does not impose a universal periodic password-change interval; a change is required when compromise is suspected or confirmed, a temporary password is issued, or the CISO directs a documented security reset.

Multifactor authentication (MFA) is required for bank email, remote access, privileged access, and systems containing Confidential or Restricted data. Use a bank-approved authenticator application or hardware security key. SMS is not an approved standard factor in this fictional policy. Privileged administrators must use a hardware security key and a separate administrative account; their everyday account must not hold standing administrator privileges.

1.3 Safe storage and enrollment

Use the bank-approved password manager. Do not place credentials in email, chat, spreadsheets, source code, browser notes, or support tickets. A manager, auditor, or Service Desk analyst must never ask for the password or a one-time MFA code. Staff must reject unexpected MFA prompts and report them as suspected compromise under section 2.3.

The Service Desk verifies identity through an existing personnel record and a callback to a registered contact before enrollment or recovery. A message from an unverified number or a manager's informal assurance is insufficient. Record verification completion, not secret answers or MFA codes, in AccessDesk.

Password and Authentication Policy

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2. Lockout, recovery, and suspected compromise

2.1 Failed attempts and sessions

After five consecutive failed password attempts, an account is locked for 15 minutes. Repeated lockouts require Service Desk review. Staff must not bypass a lockout by borrowing another person's login. Supported workstations lock after five minutes of inactivity; staff must also lock them immediately when leaving a desk. An application that cannot meet the standard needs a time-limited exception under section 3.2, not an informal workaround.

2.2 Recovery procedure

Open an AccessDesk request or contact the Service Desk using the internal directory. The analyst verifies identity using section 1.3 and checks whether a security incident may be involved. If verified, the analyst revokes the lost factor or affected sessions, issues a temporary credential where necessary, and assists enrollment of a replacement factor. Temporary passwords expire after 24 hours and must be changed at first sign-in. Send them through an approved separate delivery channel, never in the same message as the account identifier.

If identity cannot be verified, access stays blocked and the analyst escalates to the Service Desk lead. Operational urgency, including an open branch queue, does not remove verification requirements. A lost hardware key must be reported immediately so the old factor can be revoked; replacing the device alone is insufficient.

2.3 Compromise response

Suspected exposure, an unexpected MFA approval request, or a password entered into a suspicious website must be reported to the on-call Security queue immediately and no later than 15 minutes after discovery, using a safe device. Do not wait for a manager or proof of misuse. If CaseTrack is unavailable, use the on-call directory; the recipient creates the record when the system returns.

Security directs containment, including session revocation and credential reset, and links the incident to AccessDesk. Preserve the suspicious message or URL through the approved evidence process; never forward passwords. The employee must not keep using a suspected compromised account merely because the password has been changed. Return to use requires Security clearance.

Password and Authentication Policy

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3. Service accounts, exceptions, and assurance

3.1 Non-human credentials

A service account needs a named business owner, technical custodian, documented purpose, minimum access, and review date. Store secrets in the approved secrets vault, not the application repository. Prefer short-lived credentials where the system supports them. If a static service secret is necessary, rotate it at least every 90 calendar days and immediately after suspected exposure or loss of an authorized custodian's access where exposure cannot be ruled out.

Service accounts must not be used for interactive employee sign-in. Their owners review use and permissions quarterly. Disable an unused service account after the owner confirms it has no active dependency; test the change and record rollback arrangements. A human-account password's no-routine-expiry rule does not apply to static service secrets.

3.2 Exception control

The system owner requests an exception in CaseTrack before using a nonconforming system. State the affected requirement, business need, risk, compensating controls, accountable owner, and remediation date. Both the CISO and Head of Operations must approve it. An exception expires after no more than 30 calendar days and cannot authorize sharing a human account, revealing an MFA code, or skipping identity verification during recovery.

At expiry the system must comply or the affected access must stop. An extension requires a new documented risk review and both approvals; it is not automatic. Security keeps an exception register and checks expiry dates weekly. Emergency access follows LVB-08 section 2.2 and never permits a borrowed identity.

3.3 Evidence and examples

The Service Desk retains approved requests, verification completion records, recovery actions, and factor-revocation timestamps as access-management records under LVB-06 section 2.2. Security reviews lockout and unusual sign-in trends monthly without collecting passwords. Managers certify privileged access quarterly under LVB-08.

Example: a teller who forgot a password during a busy morning uses verified recovery and waits for their own account; a colleague does not lend a login. Example: a service secret found in a code repository requires immediate reporting, revocation or rotation, and an incident review even if the repository was intended to be private. These examples explain existing rules and do not create exceptions.

Information Security and Incident Response Policy

LVB-02 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
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1. Information classification and everyday safeguards

1.1 Scope and classification

This policy applies to bank information in electronic, paper, verbal, and photographed form, whether used in a branch, at head office, or remotely. Information owners assign one of four labels. Public information has an approved external release. Internal information is ordinary staff-only material. Confidential information includes internal financial reports and nonpublic business plans. Restricted information includes customer identification documents, account data, employee medical records, authentication secrets, and investigation identities.

If information is unlabelled, treat it as Confidential until its owner classifies it. If a file mixes classes, apply the highest class to the whole file unless the owner separates it safely. Public availability of one field does not make a combined customer record Public. LVB-06 provides privacy-specific handling and retention rules.

1.2 Approved systems and least privilege

Use only bank-managed devices and approved applications for Confidential or Restricted data. Access must match a recorded business need and approval in AccessDesk. Do not install unapproved software, disable endpoint protection, use personal cloud storage, or upload bank data to a public AI service. Synthetic training examples approved by the information owner may be used in an approved AI tool; real bank records must not be substituted for them.

The IT team applies critical security patches within 72 hours of its classification of a patch as critical, and high-priority patches within 14 calendar days. The system owner records testing and deployment evidence. If the deadline cannot be met, the CISO must approve documented temporary safeguards and a remediation date before expiry; the exception process in section 3.2 applies.

1.3 Physical handling

Keep Restricted paper in locked storage when unattended. Use secure-print release and collect pages immediately. Escort visitors in staff-only areas and do not allow tailgating. Dispose of records only through approved destruction bins or approved electronic deletion, after retention and hold checks. Lock screens when stepping away, even for a brief conversation.

Information Security and Incident Response Policy

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2. Incident reporting and response

2.1 What to report and when

Report suspected phishing, malware, unauthorized access, lost devices, mistaken data disclosure, missing sensitive papers, and suspicious MFA prompts immediately and no later than 15 minutes after discovery. Use the on-call Security queue in CaseTrack from a safe device. If it is unavailable, call the internal on-call contact; that recipient records the incident once service returns. A manager's permission is not required. Reporting promptly is required even if the employee caused the mistake.

Include what happened, when it was discovered, affected system or location, data type, and a safe callback route. Do not include passwords, MFA codes, complete customer documents, or speculative accusations. Preserve original messages and timestamps through Security's evidence instructions. Do not erase logs, investigate another employee's account, or contact a suspected attacker.

2.2 Immediate containment and triage

For suspected device compromise, disconnect the device from networks if safe, stop using it, and contact Security from another device. Do not factory-reset, wipe, or power off solely to remove evidence unless Security instructs it or physical safety requires it. For a misdirected email, report it; attempted recall does not replace reporting. Security assigns an incident lead and records severity, containment decisions, and evidence custody.

Active compromise of a payment service or exposure of Restricted data is Priority 1. Security acknowledges Priority 1 reports within 15 minutes of receipt and begins containment immediately. Other reports are acknowledged within one business day. Acknowledgment targets do not relax the employee's 15-minute reporting requirement.

2.3 Privacy and communication coordination

When personal data may be affected, the incident lead notifies the DPO within one hour of Security's receipt of the report. The DPO and Compliance Officer determine any external notification obligations for the scenario; this corpus supplies no statutory deadline. Only authorized communication owners may notify customers or media. Staff must not speculate in group chats or contact affected customers independently.

Information Security and Incident Response Policy

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3. Recovery, third parties, and review

3.1 Recovery and learning

The incident lead confirms containment and removal of the cause before restoration. The system owner verifies service integrity using an approved test; Security approves return to service and records any continuing monitoring. Restoring a backup does not by itself prove that unauthorized access has ended. Backups containing personal data remain subject to LVB-06 retention and hold rules.

For Priority 1 incidents, the incident lead completes a lessons-learned review within five business days after service restoration. Record the timeline, impact, evidence, root cause where established, corrective action, owner, and due date. Label an unconfirmed cause as unconfirmed. The CISO tracks overdue actions weekly and escalates unresolved high-risk actions to the Board Risk Committee through the CEO.

3.2 Third parties and exceptions

Before a supplier receives Confidential or Restricted data, the business sponsor obtains Security, DPO, and Procurement review of access, storage, incident contacts, deletion, and exit arrangements. Supplier access must have an expiry date and named sponsor. The sponsor reports a supplier incident through the same internal Security channel; a supplier's own report does not replace the bank's incident record.

A temporary exception to a technical safeguard requires CISO and relevant business-owner approval in CaseTrack, compensating controls, a responsible person, and an expiry no later than 30 calendar days. The exception cannot waive incident reporting, authorize personal cloud storage, or waive a privacy hold. Credential-specific exceptions follow the additional restrictions in LVB-01 section 3.2. The CISO checks the register weekly.

3.3 Training, records, and examples

All staff complete security induction before access to customer systems and refresher training annually. Managers track overdue completion and restrict untrained staff from sensitive tasks until training is complete. Security maintains incident records for seven years after closure; ordinary security logs follow the one-year schedule in LVB-06 unless placed on hold.

Example: a laptop lost on a train is reported within 15 minutes of discovery even if encrypted. Security determines whether remote containment is necessary and the DPO assesses personal-data impact.

Example: a customer file emailed to the wrong recipient triggers both security response and privacy assessment; it is not resolved merely by receiving a deletion promise.

Whistleblowing and Protected Reporting Policy

LVB-03 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Independent Speak-Up Reviewer | Document page 1 of 3

1. Protected concerns and reporting routes

1.1 Purpose and protection

LVB encourages honest reporting of suspected fraud, bribery, concealment of losses, customer mistreatment, falsified records, serious control failures, privacy misuse, and retaliation. A reporter need not prove wrongdoing before raising a reasonable concern. A concern that is not substantiated does not, by itself, imply dishonesty. Knowingly fabricated allegations may be addressed through the conduct process; honest mistakes remain protected.

Retaliation is prohibited against reporters, witnesses, people who assist an investigation, and staff who refuse an improper instruction. Examples include threats, unjustified shift changes, blocked training, or adverse treatment because a person raised a concern. Report suspected retaliation through any route below; it is assessed separately from the original allegation.

1.2 Available routes

Staff may use the restricted Speak-Up queue in CaseTrack, write to speakup@lumenvale.example, or request a private meeting with the Compliance Officer. Anonymous reporting is allowed through the fictional Speak-Up portal, which issues a case code for follow-up without requiring a name. These are scenario channels, not real addresses or services.

If the concern involves the Compliance Officer, CISO, People Operations lead, or CEO, use the Independent Speak-Up Reviewer through independent-review@lumenvale.example. If it involves the Board Audit Committee chair or the independence of the reviewer, route it to the non-conflicted Board Chair; if both are implicated, the non-conflicted directors appoint an external investigator. Never route a case to the person named in the allegation for intake approval.

1.3 Urgent issues and other complaints

Immediate safety or active security issues must also go to the appropriate emergency or on-call Security route; the Speak-Up acknowledgment period is not an emergency response time. Ordinary leave scheduling or expense disagreements normally go to People Operations or Finance. They may use Speak-Up if they involve misconduct, retaliation, concealment, or a conflict in the normal reporting route.

Whistleblowing and Protected Reporting Policy

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2. Intake, investigation, and updates

2.1 Information and acknowledgment

Provide the concern, approximate dates, people or functions involved, where relevant records may exist, and a safe way to communicate. Supply only records you are already authorized to access. Do not search a colleague's mailbox, remove customer files, or make covert copies to build a case. A reporter may choose not to provide an identity; anonymous reports are assessed on their available information.

The assigned intake officer acknowledges a report within two business days of receipt, using the chosen safe channel or anonymous case code. The acknowledgment explains the next step and reminds the reporter how to report retaliation. The officer records urgency, conflicts, safeguarding needs, and the assigned investigator in a restricted case. Identity information is stored separately from the general allegation summary.

2.2 Independent assessment

Within five business days of receipt, the intake officer completes an initial assessment and decides whether investigation, referral, further information, or closure is appropriate. An investigator must be independent of the subject and the disputed decision. Conflicted staff must not select the investigator, access witness identities, or approve findings. The investigator documents facts, evidence sources, interviews, and limits to the evidence without presuming guilt.

The bank protects identities on a need-to-know basis but cannot promise absolute confidentiality. If disclosure is necessary for a fair investigation or a required process, the case owner explains the proposed disclosure to the reporter where safe and practicable and records the rationale. Witnesses receive the same need-to-know protection.

2.3 Progress and conclusion

The case owner provides an update at least every ten business days while the case is open, even if the update only explains a justified delay. The internal target is to conclude within 30 business days of receipt. If this is not feasible, the owner records the reason, revised target, and next update date. The target does not justify skipping evidence or promising a particular outcome.

Whistleblowing and Protected Reporting Policy

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3. Outcomes, review, and records

3.1 Closing a case

The investigator distinguishes supported findings, unsupported allegations, and unresolved facts. The authorized decision maker approves corrective action independently of the investigation subject. The reporter receives a closure summary where contact is possible, explaining whether the concern was addressed and how to request review. The summary must not disclose another person's medical information, disciplinary details, or unrelated customer records.

The case owner records action owners and due dates and checks completion. A finding of no misconduct does not remove the duty to protect the reporter from retaliation. People Operations and the reviewer assess any reported adverse treatment without giving a line manager unnecessary access to the allegation. Temporary protective arrangements must not punish the reporter by default.

3.2 Review request

A reporter may request an independent review within ten business days of receiving a closure summary, identifying new evidence, an unmanaged conflict, or a material procedural concern. The Independent Speak-Up Reviewer appoints a non-conflicted reviewer who did not make the original finding. If that reviewer handled the original case, a non-conflicted Board Audit Committee member appoints another reviewer.

The review acknowledgment is due within two business days of receipt. The review outcome target is 15 business days; any extension requires a recorded explanation and an update to the reporter. Review can uphold the outcome, reopen fact-finding, or require corrective action. This internal route does not purport to limit rights or external routes that might exist in a real jurisdiction; none are defined by this synthetic corpus.

3.3 Record access and example

Speak-Up records are retained for seven years after case closure under LVB-06. Only assigned intake staff, independent investigators, and authorized reviewers receive case access. The Board Audit Committee receives quarterly de-identified statistics on case themes, timeliness, corrective actions, and retaliation concerns. Do not place report details in ordinary team minutes.

Example: a branch employee suspects a manager is suppressing cash discrepancies. The employee can report without the manager's permission and may use the anonymous route. They identify the dates and authorized records they observed; they do not enter other staff accounts. If a shift is changed as punishment, they report that as a separate retaliation concern linked to the case code.

Branch Operations and Cash Handling Policy

LVB-04 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Head of Operations | Document page 1 of 3

1. Opening, staffing, and customer service

1.1 Opening readiness

Branch customer hours are 09:00-16:00 on business days. Before opening, two authorized staff complete and sign the opening checklist: premises safe to enter, security systems available, workstations ready, cash records available, and required staffing present. Detailed alarm procedures, combinations, and physical-security layouts are deliberately excluded from this academic corpus.

At least two authorized staff must be present for cash-service opening. If this condition is not met, the Branch Manager delays cash service, informs the Head of Operations, records the reason, and arranges safe customer communication. No employee may conduct a dual-control task alone to avoid a queue. The manager must not pressure an employee to certify a check they did not perform.

1.2 Identity and service boundaries

Before disclosing account information or processing a transaction, staff complete the approved customer-verification workflow and record its result. A familiar face or colleague's recognition does not replace the workflow. New accounts and changes that require due diligence follow LVB-09; branch staff cannot waive missing verification documents. Customer-identification data must not be copied into ordinary chat or personal notes.

Handle customers respectfully and provide reasonable service alternatives within available procedures. Do not discuss account balances where other customers can hear. If identity is uncertain, pause the requested disclosure or transaction and refer to the Branch Manager. Do not tell the customer that an account is suspicious or reveal an internal investigation.

1.3 Dual control and allocation

Each teller uses an individually assigned till and login. Transfers into or out of shared cash custody require two authorized staff to verify the amount and record both identities. Record a transfer at the time it occurs, not at the end of the day from memory. Neither person may sign for the other. Cash-service supervision and financial review must remain separate where required by LVB-08.

Branch Operations and Cash Handling Policy

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2. Transaction controls and discrepancy response

2.1 Fictional approval thresholds

A cash payout of more than CU 5,000 requires Branch Manager approval before release, in addition to normal verification. A payout of exactly CU 5,000 does not trigger this additional amount-based approval. If the manager initiated the transaction, an authorized independent deputy or the Head of Operations approves it instead. Any suspicious pattern must be referred regardless of value.

All manual account adjustments require an independent checker before posting. The preparer records the reason, supporting evidence, affected account reference, and proposed amount. The checker verifies the evidence and authority. Staff must not split a transaction or adjustment to avoid a threshold, use a customer's identity to test a system, or approve their own work. These are internal example controls, not statutory thresholds.

2.2 Cash differences

Count and reconcile each till at close of cash service. If a difference exists, the teller and an independent checker recount once and compare authorized transaction records. Record every unresolved difference, regardless of amount, in the cash-discrepancy log on the same day. A difference exceeding CU 100 must be escalated to the Head of Operations within one hour of discovery; any suspected fraud must be escalated immediately regardless of amount.

Do not conceal a shortage with personal money, transfer a difference to another till, or alter a transaction record without the formal adjustment process. Preserve the original totals and add an explanatory correction with author and timestamp. If misconduct is suspected, use LVB-03; if a security event is suspected, the 15-minute reporting deadline in LVB-02 also applies.

2.3 Complaints and interruptions

Record customer complaints in CaseTrack on the day received and send them to the Customer Service lead. Acknowledge within two business days and provide a resolution or progress update within ten business days. A complaint involving privacy, suspected fraud, or employee misconduct also follows the relevant specialist policy. During system downtime, do not take customer credentials or make unauthorized offline postings; follow section 3.1.

Branch Operations and Cash Handling Policy

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3. Closing, continuity, and review

3.1 Service outage

The Branch Manager records the outage and notifies the Service Desk and Head of Operations. Stop transactions whose identity, balance, approval, or audit checks cannot be completed. Do not write passwords or account details on an improvised paper queue. Customer contact details collected for a callback must use an approved minimal-data form stored securely and entered into the approved system after restoration.

The Head of Operations decides whether limited services can continue under an existing approved continuity procedure. This corpus does not authorize an offline cash-payment process. Staff give the approved factual service message and available alternatives without speculation about the cause. A suspected cyber incident also follows LVB-02. Resume affected processing only after the system owner and Operations confirm readiness, with Security clearance if an incident was involved.

3.2 Closing evidence

At close, each teller reconciles the till; an independent checker reviews the result and unresolved differences. Two authorized staff verify transfer into shared custody. The Branch Manager checks the daily exception log, outstanding complaints, unposted adjustments, and handover items. The closing checklist identifies each preparer and reviewer and the time of completion.

Unresolved differences remain visible overnight as open cases with an assigned owner. They are not a reason to falsify a balanced position. The manager sends the daily reconciliation summary to Operations by 17:00. If an incident prevents completion, send a status report by 17:00 identifying missing checks and the assigned recovery owner, then complete the evidence when safe.

3.3 Oversight and examples

Operations reviews branch exceptions every business day. Finance independently reviews monthly cash-reconciliation trends under LVB-08. Records of transactions, cash transfers, adjustments, and reconciliations are retained for seven years after the transaction date or relevant financial year-end, as specified by LVB-06 section 2.2.

Example: a CU 6,000 payout needs manager approval before release. Example: a CU 80 unresolved shortage must still be logged that day; the amount alone does not trigger the over-CU-100 escalation, but suspected fraud does. Example: a sole available staff member cannot open cash service, even if customers are waiting. The branch delays cash service and escalates the staffing issue.

Staff Leave, Holidays, and Separation Policy

LVB-05 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

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1. Annual leave and absence requests

1.1 Eligibility and accrual

Full-time employees receive 20 working days of annual leave per calendar year, accruing evenly at 20/12 days per completed month of service. StaffHub stores the balance to two decimal places but calculates from the unrounded accrual. Part-time entitlement is prorated by contracted weekly hours divided by 40. New starters accrue from their first completed month; contractors are outside this employee-benefit scheme.

Annual leave is separate from sick leave and bank holidays. Employees may request leave in half-day or full-day units, subject to accrued balance. Leave in advance of accrual requires People Operations and line-manager approval and is limited to five working days. An approval must show the planned recovery from future accrual. No general entitlement to unpaid leave is established here; People Operations considers a documented request individually.

1.2 Request and decision

Submit planned leave in StaffHub at least ten business days before the first day requested. The line manager responds within three business days, considering coverage, existing approvals, and role-specific controls. People Operations resolves eligibility or balance questions. A request is not approved merely because a manager has not responded. If no decision arrives within three business days, escalate to People Operations without assuming permission to be absent.

Approved leave changes require consultation with the employee and a recorded business reason. Managers should first seek voluntary coverage changes. A refusal must explain the operational reason and suggest alternative dates. An employee may ask People Operations to review inconsistent treatment or a calculation error; misconduct or retaliation concerns may use LVB-03.

1.3 Handover

Before leave, record open tasks, deadlines, and the delegated role in an approved team location. Delegation does not authorize password sharing or transfer of an individual's approval authority. Access changes must use AccessDesk. Employees handling cash, payment approval, or privileged administration must take at least five consecutive working days of annual leave each calendar year, scheduled with their manager for continuity and independent oversight.

Staff Leave, Holidays, and Separation Policy

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2. Carryover, sickness, and fictional holidays

2.1 Carryover

Up to five unused annual-leave days may carry into the next calendar year. Carried days must be used by 31 March and are used before the new year's balance. Any unused carried balance expires after 31 March unless People Operations approved an extension in writing because documented bank-required cancellation prevented use. The extension must specify the days and new expiry date; it is not automatic.

Amounts above five days do not carry automatically. People Operations reviews a documented bank-caused cancellation before year-end and records any exceptional treatment. The corpus does not provide a general right to exchange leave for cash during employment. Separation calculations are handled under section 3.3 without inventing a payout rule.

2.2 Sick leave

Full-time employees receive ten paid working days of sick leave per calendar year; part-time allocation is prorated by weekly hours divided by 40. Sick leave does not accrue monthly, carry over, or convert to annual leave. Notify the line manager as soon as practicable and no later than one hour after the scheduled start time, unless an emergency prevents contact. In that case notify when safe, directly or through a trusted contact.

For more than two consecutive working days of sickness, People Operations requests appropriate supporting documentation. Send medical documents through the restricted People Operations channel, not a team group chat. Managers receive absence dates and necessary work adjustments, not diagnoses. People Operations handles exhausted sick balances and longer absences individually; this corpus does not define additional statutory or family-leave entitlements.

2.3 Holiday calendar

The fictional bank observes four annual holidays: 1 January (New Year Day), 15 April (Community Day), 1 July (Founders Day), and 25 December (Winter Day). If a holiday falls on Saturday or Sunday, it is observed on the following Monday. These dates are invented and are not a real country's holiday calendar. Branches close on observed holidays. They do not deduct annual leave. Required on-call coverage is agreed in advance; an employee who works an observed holiday receives one replacement working day off within 30 calendar days, scheduled with the manager.

Staff Leave, Holidays, and Separation Policy

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3. Resignation, termination, and offboarding

3.1 Initiation and coordination

For this fictional employment model, an employee submits resignation in writing to the manager and People Operations, normally giving 30 calendar days' notice. People Operations may agree a different end date in writing. Employer-initiated separation requires People Operations review, a recorded reason, an authorized decision maker, and an opportunity for the employee to respond where appropriate. This policy does not state jurisdiction-specific dismissal grounds, notice laws, severance, or appeal rights.

People Operations opens a restricted offboarding checklist showing the agreed last working time, access-removal time, asset return, handover, record ownership, and responsible teams. The employee transfers business records through approved systems; they must not send work files to a personal address. A manager must identify successors for service-account ownership, approvals, and open cases before the employee leaves.

3.2 Access and property

For a planned departure, IT disables accounts, sessions, remote access, and building credentials at the agreed end of the final working period. For an immediate separation or security-risk departure, IT disables access at the time specified by People Operations in coordination with Security, before or during notification as appropriate. Do not wait for payroll processing. Security preserves records and evidence before disposal; disabling access does not authorize deleting a mailbox.

Collect bank devices, hardware keys, cards, documents, and other assigned property by the last working day, recording returned and outstanding items. IT verifies completion in AccessDesk, and the manager verifies handover. Any suspected data removal is reported under LVB-02, including its 15-minute reporting requirement. Outstanding property is recorded and followed up rather than concealed as complete.

3.3 Closure and retention

People Operations confirms the recorded final leave balance and refers any payment or deduction calculation to the employee's applicable fictional contract and approved payroll decision. No universal cash-payout formula is supplied by this corpus. The checklist should close within two business days after departure or remain open with named owners for unresolved items. Personnel and leave records are retained for six years after departure under LVB-06; holds override deletion. The manager may not retain a private duplicate personnel file.

Data Protection, Privacy, and Retention Policy

LVB-06 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Data Protection Officer | Document page 1 of 3

1. Purpose, collection, and permitted use

1.1 Scope and principles

Personal data means information about an identifiable customer, employee, applicant, supplier contact, or other person in this fictional bank. Collect only information needed for an approved purpose, explain that purpose, keep data accurate, restrict access, and retain it only under the schedule in section 2.2. Do not reuse a customer record for an unrelated purpose merely because the bank already holds it.

The business owner documents the purpose and justification for each processing activity in the privacy register before launch. The DPO reviews new uses, sensitive datasets, automated decisions, and new suppliers before data is collected or transferred. This policy defines internal controls, not a legal basis under any real jurisdiction. Consent is not presumed from silence, and staff must not claim that every bank activity depends on consent.

1.2 Minimum necessary data

Use the approved form and avoid free-text copies of identity documents, medical details, or payment records. Explain required and optional fields. Do not collect full identity documents when an approved verification result is sufficient for the task. Customer onboarding follows the specific requirements in LVB-09; this minimization rule does not permit staff to omit required due-diligence evidence.

For training, testing, demonstrations, and this academic application, use synthetic records. A masked name does not necessarily anonymize a record if other fields identify the person. Do not put actual customer examples in the academic repository. Medical evidence goes only to the restricted People Operations channel; a line manager receives the operational absence information needed to arrange coverage.

1.3 Accuracy and changes

Staff who find an inaccurate record submit a correction request through the owning system rather than overwriting audit history. Verify a customer's identity before changing contact or identity information, and preserve the reason, source, date, and author of the update. Suspected identity misuse also goes to Compliance. The DPO resolves questions about a new purpose, excessive collection, or proposed external disclosure before the activity proceeds.

Data Protection, Privacy, and Retention Policy

LVB-06 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Data Protection Officer | Document page 2 of 3

2. Sharing, retention, and disposal

2.1 Controlled sharing

Share personal data only with an authorized recipient for a recorded business purpose and through an approved encrypted channel. Check recipient identity, address, classification, and minimum content before sending. A colleague's seniority does not create a need to know. Suppliers need business-owner, Security, DPO, and Procurement review before receiving Confidential or Restricted information, consistent with LVB-02 section 3.2.

The DPO and Compliance Officer review external demands for records, including requests claiming official authority. Frontline staff must not disclose directly or promise a legal outcome. An accidental disclosure is a security incident: report within 15 minutes of discovery under LVB-02. A deletion request from a recipient does not replace an incident report.

2.2 Authoritative retention schedule

Customer due-diligence and account-opening records: seven years after the customer relationship ends. Transaction records and cash-transfer evidence: seven years after the transaction date. Financial reconciliations, manual-adjustment review packs, and expense records: seven years after the relevant financial year-end; LVB's financial year ends 31 December. Approved public statements and their approval packs: seven years after publication.

Personnel, leave, and offboarding records: six years after employee departure. Security incident, whistleblowing, privacy-request, and control-exception cases: seven years after case closure. Ordinary security logs: one year after creation. Access-management requests and access-review evidence: two years after request closure or review completion. Routine internal communication: two years after creation, unless it is evidence of a transaction, personnel decision, or case, in which case retain it with that record for the applicable longer period.

2.3 Holds and deletion

A legal, investigation, or audit hold suspends ordinary deletion for the records it covers. The hold owner records scope and release in CaseTrack; only written release permits normal disposal to resume. Owners review expired records quarterly, confirm holds, obtain a second-person check, and record secure deletion or approved destruction. Backups expire on a documented 90-calendar-day rolling cycle; deleted live records are not restored into routine use from backup. A hold requires preservation of relevant backup evidence beyond the normal cycle where necessary.

Data Protection, Privacy, and Retention Policy

LVB-06 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Data Protection Officer | Document page 3 of 3

3. Privacy requests, assessment, and oversight

3.1 Request intake and verification

Anyone receiving a request to access, correct, or delete personal data must send it to the DPO's restricted Privacy queue by the end of the next business day. Staff must not refuse a request because it uses informal wording. Record the receipt time and request type using minimal data, and avoid sending full account files into the intake record.

The DPO acknowledges receipt within three business days of the bank's original receipt and verifies identity through an approved process before releasing information or making sensitive changes. The internal response target is 20 business days from original receipt. If identity or scope remains unresolved, the DPO explains the issue, records the reason for delay, and provides a revised target. These are invented internal service targets, not statutory time limits.

3.2 Review and response

The DPO checks scope, identity, third-party information, retention duties within this corpus, and any hold before deciding. A deletion request does not override an active hold or automatically erase a required record. If deletion is not possible, explain the applicable reason and any available restriction of use without claiming a legal exemption that the corpus does not define. Record what was searched, what was disclosed or changed, the decision, and reviewer approval.

For a possible personal-data incident, Security notifies the DPO within one hour of receiving the incident report. The DPO assesses data types, people affected, safeguards, likely impact, and appropriate response with Compliance. External notification decisions are documented; this corpus does not establish regulator names, legal thresholds, or statutory breach deadlines.

3.3 Oversight and example

The DPO reviews the privacy register and open requests quarterly and reports overdue actions to the Board Risk Committee. New high-impact processing requires a documented privacy-impact review before launch, including necessity, affected people, data flows, risks, mitigations, and accountable owner. An unresolved high risk goes to the DPO and relevant executive for a recorded stop-or-proceed decision.

Example: a former customer asks for immediate deletion of onboarding documents one year after account closure. The DPO verifies identity and explains the seven-year post-relationship schedule. Staff do not promise immediate erasure or disclose records before verification. Any active hold is checked separately and can require retention beyond the scheduled period.

Ethics, Conflicts, and Staff Conduct Policy

LVB-07 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Head of People Operations | Document page 1 of 3

1. Professional conduct and customer treatment

1.1 Expected behavior

Staff must act honestly, treat customers and colleagues respectfully, follow approved controls, and keep accurate records. Discrimination, harassment, bullying, intimidation, retaliation, and deliberate deception are prohibited. A sales target, manager's instruction, or customer's request does not authorize falsifying a record, bypassing verification, or concealing a complaint.

Explain products only within the approved information available for the role. Do not promise approval, returns, fees, or rates not stated in authorized product material. The academic corpus does not contain lending criteria or interest rates, so the policy assistant must not invent them. Where a customer needs an answer outside the employee's authority, refer to the authorized product or service owner.

1.2 Confidentiality and account access

Use customer and employee records only for an assigned business purpose. Looking up a friend, relative, public figure, or colleague out of curiosity is prohibited even if system access technically allows it. Staff must not process their own account transactions or approve transactions for a close relative. Route such matters to an independent authorized colleague and record the conflict without sharing unnecessary personal detail.

Do not discuss Confidential or Restricted information in public spaces, personal messages, social media, or unapproved AI tools. Leaving the bank does not authorize disclosure of information obtained during employment. Data retention and legitimate disclosure follow LVB-06; confidentiality is not an excuse to hide evidence from an authorized independent investigation.

1.3 Fair handling of concerns

Managers listen to concerns without prejudging the outcome and refer specialist matters to the appropriate owner. Staff may challenge an instruction that appears inconsistent with policy and seek a written explanation. If the concern involves the manager, use an independent channel. Whistleblowing and retaliation protections in LVB-03 apply to good-faith reports, including reports that ultimately cannot be substantiated.

Ethics, Conflicts, and Staff Conduct Policy

LVB-07 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Head of People Operations | Document page 2 of 3

2. Gifts, outside interests, and conflicts

2.1 Gifts and hospitality

Cash, cash equivalents, personal loans from customers or suppliers, and gifts intended to influence a decision are prohibited regardless of value. A noncash gift or hospitality valued at CU 50 or less may be accepted only if occasional, unsolicited, unrelated to a pending decision, and unlikely to create obligation. Record every accepted item in the gift register within two business days.

An item worth more than CU 50 requires written Compliance Officer approval before acceptance. If advance approval is impossible, decline it or place it in bank custody pending a decision; do not use it personally. Once a giver's cumulative accepted value would exceed CU 100 in a calendar year, Compliance approval is required before that additional item is accepted, even if each item is individually below CU 50.

No gift or hospitality from a bidder may be accepted by a person participating in the active procurement decision, regardless of value. Compliance approval cannot override this prohibition. If the Compliance Officer is the recipient, the non-conflicted Head of People Operations and Board Audit Committee chair make the decision. An item suspected to be a bribe must be reported through LVB-03.

2.2 Conflicts and outside work

Disclose an actual, potential, or apparent conflict to the manager and Compliance Officer before participating in the affected decision. Examples include a relative's supplier bid, an ownership interest in a customer business, or outside paid work for a bank vendor. Declare relevant interests on joining, annually, and within five business days of a material change. An annual declaration does not remove the need to disclose before a specific decision.

Outside paid work requires manager and Compliance approval before it starts. They assess conflicts, confidentiality, working-time impact, and use of bank resources. Approval is not permission to use customer information or bank equipment for the outside role. A conflicted employee must step out of the decision until a documented management plan identifies an independent decision maker.

Ethics, Conflicts, and Staff Conduct Policy

LVB-07 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Head of People Operations | Document page 3 of 3

3. Investigation, action, and examples

3.1 Raising a conduct concern

An employee may raise ordinary conduct concerns with People Operations, the manager, or the Speak-Up route. Security incidents still require reporting within 15 minutes under LVB-02; do not wait for a conduct investigation. A privacy issue goes to the DPO as well as any applicable incident channel. People Operations records intake, checks conflicts, and assigns a fair process without asking a subject of the allegation to approve investigation of themselves.

3.2 Fair process and outcomes

The investigator gathers relevant information, distinguishes fact from inference, and gives the employee an appropriate opportunity to respond. Restrict information to people who need it for the process. Interim access restrictions may protect information or customers while facts are assessed; they are not a finding of guilt. People Operations records reasons and reviews continuing necessity.

Possible internal outcomes include no action, coaching, training, changes to duties, a formal warning, or separation after the authorized review. This list does not establish mandatory employment sanctions or real-world legal procedures. A manager must not impose an automatic penalty based solely on an allegation or make a payroll deduction outside an approved process. Separation coordination follows LVB-05 section 3.

An employee may request a review of a conduct decision through People Operations within ten business days of notification, identifying an error, new evidence, or procedural concern. A manager who made the original decision must not decide the review. People Operations acknowledges within three business days and records the reviewer and planned completion date. Whistleblowing review timelines are separately defined in LVB-03.

3.3 Training and examples

Staff complete conduct induction before customer-facing duties and annual refresher training. People Operations tracks completion; Compliance reviews the gift and conflict registers quarterly. Conduct records form part of the restricted personnel file, retained for six years after departure unless a longer case schedule or hold applies under LVB-06.

Example: a CU 40 meal from a supplier may still be prohibited during an active procurement decision. Example: three CU 40 gifts from one giver would total CU 120; the third requires prior Compliance approval even if no other prohibition applies. Example: an employee cannot view a relative's balance simply because the relative verbally asked them at a family gathering; the relative must use an authorized service process.

Internal Control, Approvals, and Assurance Policy

LVB-08 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Finance Controller | Document page 1 of 3

1. Control ownership and segregation of duties

1.1 Responsibilities

Business managers own and operate controls in their processes. Finance, Compliance, Security, and the DPO provide specialist oversight within their responsibilities. Internal Audit independently tests the design and operation of controls and reports to the Board Audit Committee. Internal Audit must not prepare the reconciliation or approval evidence it later audits.

Each key control has a documented purpose, owner, frequency, evidence location, independent reviewer where required, and escalation route. The control register links to the relevant policy section and system record. A ticked checklist without supporting evidence is not proof that a control operated. Staff must not backdate a sign-off or use another person's identity.

1.2 Maker and checker

The person preparing a manual account adjustment cannot approve it. The person requesting their own expense cannot approve reimbursement. The person creating or changing a supplier's bank details cannot be the sole approver of the related payment. Access provisioning requires business-owner approval, and privileged access also requires CISO approval. The Service Desk implements the approved change; approval and implementation evidence must be distinguishable.

If a small team cannot separate duties locally, route the check to an authorized independent person in Operations or Finance before execution. Staff absence does not justify self-approval. Branch-specific cash controls are in LVB-04. Expense approval levels in LVB-11 govern expense claims and do not replace branch payout controls; equal monetary values in different processes do not imply equal approval authority.

1.3 Reconciliations and certification

Branches reconcile tills daily at close. Finance reviews the monthly general-ledger reconciliation within five business days after month-end, with an independent reviewer within the next two business days. Record unresolved items with amounts, age, owner, reason, and action date. Do not clear an item just to meet a deadline. Managers certify user access quarterly, including role fit, leavers, dormant accounts, and privileged permissions; privileged access review includes Security.

Internal Control, Approvals, and Assurance Policy

LVB-08 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Finance Controller | Document page 2 of 3

2. Exceptions, urgent access, and escalation

2.1 Control failures

Record a missed control or suspected control failure in the Control Exceptions queue by the end of the day of discovery. Notify the control owner promptly. A high-risk failure involving possible fraud, unauthorized payment, or Restricted-data exposure must be escalated immediately to the relevant specialist owner; security-related failures also follow the 15-minute requirement in LVB-02.

The control owner assesses impact, interim safeguards, responsible staff, and an action deadline within two business days of the report. If exposure remains active, containment begins immediately rather than waiting for assessment completion. Finance tracks financial exceptions, while the relevant specialist tracks their own corrective actions. An exception is closed only after evidence shows the fix has been implemented and independently checked.

2.2 Emergency access

Emergency elevated access requires a named requester, documented incident or business-continuity reason, system scope, CISO or on-call Security delegate approval, and approval by an independent business owner. Record both approvals before activation. Use the employee's named emergency account with MFA and activity logging, never a shared login. If approvals cannot be obtained, do not grant access; escalate service continuity to Operations.

Access expires after at most four hours and must be removed sooner when the task is complete. Any extension is a new request requiring both approvals. Security reviews activity by the end of the next business day and records whether the access matched its purpose. Emergency access does not authorize self-approval of payments, disabling logging, or bypassing customer verification. Credential recovery still follows LVB-01 identity checks.

2.3 Unresolved and overdue items

Owners review open high-risk exceptions each business day. Any overdue high-risk action is escalated to the CEO and Board Audit Committee through the Finance Controller, with a risk explanation and revised plan. Other overdue actions are reviewed weekly by the relevant executive. A revised date does not erase the original deadline or evidence of delay. Retain the change history and approval rationale.

Internal Control, Approvals, and Assurance Policy

LVB-08 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027

Owner: Finance Controller | Document page 3 of 3

3. Monitoring, change control, and assurance

3.1 Business-system changes

A change to a payment, customer, identity, or financial-reporting system requires a request describing purpose, risk, test results, approvals, rollback plan, and planned implementation window. The business owner approves the intended behavior; IT approves technical readiness; Security reviews security-impacting changes. The implementer must not be the sole tester or approver of a material change.

An emergency change uses the same minimum recorded purpose, risk, independent approval, and rollback plan before execution, with missing routine documentation completed by the end of the next business day. Emergency labeling cannot waive the named-account, logging, or transaction-separation controls. The owner verifies successful operation and records any rollback or incident.

3.2 Management review and audit

The Finance Controller provides a monthly control dashboard to senior management: overdue reconciliations, unresolved cash differences, emergency access, overdue remediation, and repeated exceptions. The dashboard uses aggregate data where possible and does not include unnecessary customer identifiers. A recurring low-value difference may indicate a wider issue and must not be ignored solely because it is below an amount threshold.

Internal Audit chooses its review samples independently, checks evidence against the control register, and reports findings with owners and dates. The Board Audit Committee reviews remediation progress quarterly. Managers supply complete records and must not coach staff to conceal failures. Retention follows LVB-06: financial reconciliation packs are seven years after financial year-end, access-review evidence is two years after completion, and control-exception cases are seven years after closure.

3.3 Worked control examples

A staff member creates a CU 200 manual account adjustment. An independent authorized checker is required even though the amount is below the branch cash-payout threshold; these are different controls. A manager submits an expense claim and routes approval upward rather than approving it themselves. A payment system fails and an engineer receives emergency access for two hours after the required approvals; access is removed when work finishes after 40 minutes, and Security reviews the activity by the next business-day end.

When a control is not described, staff ask the process owner for a written procedure. They must not interpret silence as permission to omit review. A new recurring control should be documented and approved through policy governance before being represented as an existing rule in the policy assistant.

Know Your Customer and Know Your Customer's Business Policy

LVB-09 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Compliance Officer | Document page 1 of 3

1. Customer identification and business understanding

1.1 Purpose and scope

Before activating a customer relationship, LVB verifies who the customer is, why the service is needed, and what activity is reasonably expected. Know Your Customer (KYC) covers individuals and their authorized representatives. Know Your Customer's Business (KYB) covers business identity, ownership, control, and expected operations. This is a fictional due-diligence framework, not a statement of legal anti-money-laundering requirements.

The onboarding employee collects approved evidence, records verification results, and assigns the case for independent review. The Branch Manager checks completeness, while Compliance decides high-risk cases and unresolved screening concerns. No employee may activate an account using their own approval of incomplete evidence. Revenue targets and personal familiarity do not justify bypassing the process.

1.2 Individual customers

Record the customer's legal name, date of birth, residential address, valid identity evidence, purpose of the account, occupation or activity, and expected source and pattern of funds. Verify identity and address through approved independent sources. An image of a document alone is not automatically sufficient: record the approved verification method, result, reviewer, and date. Resolve inconsistencies before activation.

For someone acting for another person, verify the representative's identity and documented authority, as well as the customer's required information. Do not accept a relative's informal statement as authority. If evidence is unavailable or unreliable, pause onboarding and ask Compliance for an approved alternative or a decline decision. This corpus does not enumerate acceptable real-world identity-document types.

1.3 Business customers

Record legal and trading names, registration evidence, registered and operating addresses, nature of business, expected transaction activity, source of funds, authorized signatories, ownership structure, and natural persons who ultimately own or control the business. Verify the entity and signatory authority using approved independent evidence. Understand what the business sells, its principal customer and supplier types, and why the requested services fit that activity. A registration certificate alone does not complete KYB.

Know Your Customer and Know Your Customer's Business Policy

LVB-09 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Compliance Officer | Document page 2 of 3

2. Ownership, risk assessment, and approval

2.1 Beneficial ownership

For this fictional policy, identify and verify each natural person who directly or indirectly owns 25% or more of the business, plus any person exercising control through other means. Exactly 25% qualifies. Trace ownership through intermediate entities; do not stop at a company name. If no natural person meets the ownership threshold, identify and verify the senior managing official and document the ownership and control assessment. This fallback must not conceal an unresolved or opaque ownership chain.

If reliable ownership or control information cannot be obtained, do not activate the relationship. Compliance decides whether more evidence can resolve the issue or onboarding must be declined. The 25% threshold is an invented internal rule for the project and is not presented as the law of any country.

2.2 Risk assessment and screening

Assess customer activity, ownership complexity, expected transaction pattern, delivery channel, and inconsistencies in evidence. Use the approved screening process for customers, relevant owners, and signatories. A possible match is unresolved until Compliance reviews identifiers and evidence. Staff must not label someone sanctioned or suspicious solely because a name resembles another entry, and must not override a match to finish onboarding.

Low-risk cases have verified straightforward identity and activity. Medium-risk cases require additional explanation or monitoring but have resolved evidence. High-risk cases include materially complex ownership or other concerns requiring enhanced review. An unresolved screening match or unverifiable identity blocks activation; it is not cured simply by assigning a high-risk rating.

2.3 Enhanced due diligence

For a high-risk case, obtain additional corroboration of source of funds, source of wealth where relevant to the assessed risk, ownership, business purpose, and expected activity. Source of funds describes where money for the relationship comes from; source of wealth describes how overall wealth was accumulated. Record the rationale and monitoring plan. Both the Compliance Officer and Head of Operations must approve a high-risk relationship before activation. Neither may approve their own prepared assessment without an independent review. This approval cannot waive missing identity or unresolved screening evidence.

Know Your Customer and Know Your Customer's Business Policy

LVB-09 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Compliance Officer | Document page 3 of 3

3. Ongoing review, concerns, and records

3.1 Review schedule and triggers

Review low-risk relationships every 36 months, medium-risk every 24 months, and high-risk every 12 months from the last completed review or initial approval. A calendar reminder alone is not a completed review. Confirm that identity, ownership, authorized signatories, purpose, and expected activity remain accurate, and record the evidence and next due date.

Changes in ownership, signatories, business activity, transaction pattern, or credible adverse information trigger a review without waiting for the periodic due date. The employee who notices the change refers it to Compliance by the end of the next business day. Compliance assesses urgency and records required restrictions and an action plan within two business days of referral. If active fraud or a security incident is suspected, the immediate specialist reporting routes apply as well.

3.2 Unusual activity and confidentiality

Record unusual activity facts in the restricted Customer Review queue and notify Compliance by the end of the same business day. If there is active suspected fraud or imminent loss, notify Compliance and Operations immediately. Do not independently tell the customer that an internal suspicion report or investigation exists, promise that activity is lawful, or advise how to avoid a threshold.

Compliance evaluates the facts, decides further internal action, and records any external reporting assessment. This corpus does not define statutory reporting forms, regulator identities, filing deadlines, or legal tipping-off rules. Staff must not invent these details. An unusual transaction is a reason for assessment, not proof of wrongdoing.

3.3 Retention and examples

Retain KYC and KYB evidence for seven years after the customer relationship ends; transactions follow their separate transaction-date schedule in LVB-06. Restrict records to authorized onboarding, review, and oversight staff. A hold suspends normal deletion. Corrections preserve original evidence and the reason for change rather than silently replacing a prior record.

Example: a business has four equal natural-person owners. All four meet the 25% threshold and must be identified and verified. Example: a low-risk customer's business changes substantially six months after review; staff trigger a new assessment rather than waiting 36 months. Example: a registration certificate with no verified ownership or signatory authority is insufficient for activation.

Internal and Corporate Communication Policy

LVB-10 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Head of Corporate Communication | Document page 1 of 3

1. Internal channels and message handling

1.1 Approved channels

Use bank email for formal internal correspondence, the approved staff chat for routine coordination, PolicyHub for current policies, StaffHub for leave and expenses, AccessDesk for access approvals, and the relevant restricted CaseTrack queue for incidents and investigations. A chat message can alert an owner that a request exists but does not replace approval in the required workflow.

Do not use personal email, personal messaging accounts, or public social-media groups for bank business involving Confidential or Restricted information. Classification follows LVB-02; a message with mixed data receives the highest applicable classification. Before sharing, check the recipient, business need, classification, and minimum necessary content. Restricted case identities must not appear in general team channels.

1.2 Response expectations and urgent messages

For ordinary internal email requiring action, acknowledge within two business days or set an out-of-office message naming an authorized alternate. This is an acknowledgment target, not a promise to complete every request in two days. The sender identifies the action, owner, and requested date. The recipient should clarify an unrealistic deadline and route the work appropriately.

Urgent security incidents use the on-call Security route within 15 minutes of discovery; do not rely on a manager reading email. Whistleblowing, privacy, and customer complaints use their own timelines. A general communication service target never extends a shorter policy deadline. If a restricted system is unavailable, use its documented fallback rather than an unapproved public channel.

1.3 Meetings and decisions

Record material decisions, approvals, action owners, and due dates in the approved system or team record. Do not include unnecessary medical, customer, or investigation details in minutes. A verbal instruction that needs formal approval is not effective until the required authorized record exists. Staff may ask for the written decision and escalate pressure to bypass this control through LVB-07 or LVB-03.

Internal and Corporate Communication Policy

LVB-10 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Head of Corporate Communication | Document page 2 of 3

2. External statements and customer notices

2.1 Spokespeople and authorization

Only the CEO, Head of Corporate Communication, or a specifically designated written delegate may speak to the media on behalf of LVB. Employees who receive a media inquiry record the contact details and topic, refer it to Corporate Communication promptly, and make no substantive comment. Personal views must not be presented as bank statements, and confidentiality obligations still apply outside work.

Routine customer service may use approved templates within an employee's role. New public statements, marketing claims, and changes to standard customer notices need Corporate Communication and the relevant business-owner approval before release. Compliance reviews statements about products, obligations, or customer impact; the DPO reviews proposed personal-data disclosure. Do not invent product claims that are absent from approved material.

2.2 Incident and service communication

For a major incident, Corporate Communication prepares one controlled message using facts confirmed by the incident lead. Security verifies technical incident facts; Operations verifies service availability; the DPO and Compliance review privacy and reporting implications. The CEO or designated spokesperson approves the public release. No one should promise restoration times, absence of data loss, or compensation without an approved factual basis.

Branch staff may issue an already approved service-outage template after the Head of Operations confirms its applicability. If no template fits, escalate rather than drafting speculation. Any required customer or external notification decision is made by the authorized owners under LVB-02 and LVB-06. This policy supplies no legal notification timetable.

2.3 Publication checks

Before publishing, verify audience, facts, date, version, accessible wording, contact route, approval evidence, and absence of unnecessary personal data. Use only official accounts with assigned custodians and MFA. A second authorized person checks the final version against the approved text. Record who published, where, when, and which version. A draft in a shared folder is not publication approval.

Internal and Corporate Communication Policy

LVB-10 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Head of Corporate Communication | Document page 3 of 3

3. Corrections, records, and examples

3.1 Errors and unauthorized disclosures

Report a materially inaccurate published statement to Corporate Communication immediately. Stop scheduled reuse where authorized, preserve the original version and approval history, and request a correction decision. Do not silently rewrite a significant claim so that the prior statement cannot be reconstructed. Corporate Communication coordinates a corrected version, publication time, audience, and explanation appropriate to the impact.

If the error discloses personal or Restricted information, also report it to Security within 15 minutes of discovery. Deleting a post or recalling an email does not remove the incident-reporting obligation. Security and the DPO assess the disclosure; Corporate Communication manages approved external wording. Staff must not contact all affected people independently before that coordinated decision.

3.2 Policy changes and records

Policy owners publish approved revisions through PolicyHub with version, effective date, owner, and change summary. Corporate Communication helps notify affected staff. An email summary must link to the authoritative version rather than become an untracked alternative policy. Staff acknowledge material policy updates within five business days of the request; managers follow up on overdue acknowledgments.

Routine internal communication is retained for two years after creation. Messages that support a transaction, employment decision, incident, or investigation inherit the relevant longer record schedule in LVB-06. Approved public statements and their approval packs are retained for seven years after publication as a specific communication record class. Holds suspend deletion. Corporate Communication owns this additional schedule and coordinates disposal with the DPO.

3.3 Examples and training

A journalist asks a teller whether a branch outage was a cyberattack. The teller records the inquiry and refers it to Corporate Communication, using only the approved customer-service message. A manager requests an expense approval by chat; the employee submits the StaffHub claim and obtains the required approval there. An employee sees an incorrect public fee claim; they report it immediately and preserve the published version rather than replacing it without review.

Staff receive communication and confidentiality guidance at induction. Official-account custodians receive role-specific publishing training before access is granted, and their access is reviewed quarterly. Departing custodians hand over account ownership through AccessDesk; they do not share their password with a successor.

Remote Work, Travel, and Expense Policy

LVB-11 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Oct 2026 | Review 01 Oct 2027
Owner: Head of Operations | Document page 1 of 3

1. Remote-work eligibility and safeguards

1.1 Eligibility and approval

Employees whose duties can be performed securely away from a branch may request up to two remote-working days per week. Branch cash-handling duties are not eligible while assigned to cash service. Eligibility is not automatic: the line manager approves coverage and performance arrangements, and People Operations records the arrangement in StaffHub before it starts. The approved arrangement identifies location, days, review date, and contact expectations.

Normal remote arrangements last up to three months before review. A manager may change the schedule for documented service or security reasons after discussing it with the employee. Remote work does not expand working hours, create extra leave, or authorize work from an unapproved location. This corpus does not authorize cross-border working; refer such requests to People Operations for a separate assessment.

1.2 Security and workspace

Use a bank-managed device, approved remote connection, MFA, and a private workspace that prevents others seeing or hearing customer information. Personal devices must not access Confidential or Restricted bank data. Do not print Restricted information at home, let household members use the bank device, or transfer files to personal storage. Lock the screen whenever leaving it and keep equipment secure between sessions.

Avoid public Wi-Fi. If an approved task must be done away from the approved workspace, obtain manager approval and use a bank-approved connection such as a managed hotspot; never disable security controls to make a connection work. A lost device or suspected disclosure is reported within 15 minutes under LVB-02, including outside normal office hours through the on-call route.

1.3 Availability and disruption

Be available during the agreed work schedule and update the approved calendar. For a connection outage, notify the manager promptly, stop work that cannot be completed securely, and agree a return-to-office or alternative assignment. Do not use an unapproved personal account to keep a task moving. The manager records any change that affects coverage or working arrangements.

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2. Travel authorization and reimbursable expenses

2.1 Approval before spending

Business travel requires written line-manager approval in StaffHub before booking. Record the purpose, dates, destination, expected cost, and cost center. If the estimated total trip cost exceeds CU 1,000, also obtain Finance Controller approval before booking. Exactly CU 1,000 does not trigger the additional amount-based trip approval. Travelers must not divide a booking to avoid the threshold.

Where the line manager is the traveler, approval goes to their next-level manager. A Finance Controller's own trip requiring Finance-level approval is routed to the CEO and an independent Finance reviewer. Emergency travel still needs an authorized written approval before commitment; urgency does not create self-approval. The bank may decline reimbursement for spending outside approved scope, subject to documented review.

2.2 Eligible costs and limits

Reimburse reasonable, necessary business costs supported by receipts: approved transport, accommodation, meals during approved business travel, and approved business supplies. Hotel reimbursement is capped at CU 150 per night excluding separately itemized mandatory lodging taxes. Meals are capped at CU 40 per travel day including taxes and tips. These are reimbursement ceilings, not automatic allowances; claim actual eligible spending.

Alcohol, entertainment unrelated to the approved purpose, personal purchases, penalties, companion travel, and ordinary commuting are not reimbursable. Personal vehicle business mileage is reimbursed at CU 0.30 per kilometer using an approved route log; ordinary commuting is excluded. Staff must not also claim fuel for the same mileage. Remote-working days do not automatically qualify for internet, furniture, or utility reimbursement.

2.3 Above-limit requests

A hotel or meal expense above its cap needs prior written Finance Controller approval, with the reason and approved maximum recorded in StaffHub. Approval of the trip alone does not waive a category cap. If an unexpected essential cost could not reasonably be preapproved, explain it promptly; Finance assesses it individually and reimbursement is not guaranteed. Gift and hospitality restrictions in LVB-07 still apply to spending claimed as a business expense.

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3. Claims, review, and exceptions

3.1 Submission and evidence

Submit an expense claim within 15 calendar days after the trip ends or, for a non-travel expense, after the purchase date. Attach itemized receipts, business purpose, dates, cost center, prior approvals, and a mileage log where applicable. If a receipt is missing, provide a signed explanation and alternative evidence for Finance review; a missing receipt is not automatically approved or automatically evidence of misconduct.

The line manager checks business purpose and approved scope. Finance checks calculations, category limits, duplicate claims, and evidence. An expense claim totaling more than CU 500 requires Finance Controller approval in addition to manager approval before payment. Exactly CU 500 does not trigger this extra claim-total approval. A CU 900 trip may therefore need no additional trip-budget approval but still need Finance Controller approval for its claim. Trip and claim thresholds govern different steps.

3.2 Payment and correction

Finance targets payment within ten business days after all required approvals and complete evidence are received. The clock does not start with an incomplete first submission. If information is missing, Finance returns the claim with a specific explanation and records the remaining requirement. Employees may correct a claim without altering the original receipt or hiding a prior submission.

Late claims require a reason and Finance Controller review; the policy provides no automatic late-claim entitlement. Employees must not approve their own expenses at any level. An approver's own claim goes to the next-level manager and an independent Finance approver; CEO claims go to the Board Audit Committee chair and an independent Finance reviewer. Suspected fabricated or duplicate claims follow LVB-07 and, where appropriate, LVB-03.

3.3 Records and examples

Keep expense claims and supporting records for seven years after the relevant financial year-end under LVB-06. Remote-work approvals are personnel records retained for six years after departure. People Operations and Operations review remote arrangements at least every three months; Finance reviews expense exceptions quarterly for repeated issues.

Example: CU 32 in eligible meals yields CU 32 reimbursement, not the CU 40 cap. Example: a teller assigned to cash service cannot perform that duty remotely. Example: a claim with CU 480 in hotel charges and CU 60 in eligible meals totals CU 540 and needs the additional claim-total approval, even when each category is within its daily cap.